

However, the Moto G54 with the Dimensity 7020 surpasses the X6 Neo's scores by a slight margin. In GeekBench, the POCO X6 Neo scored 756 in the Single Core test and 1961 in the Multi Core test. So, it lagged behind both the Lava Storm and the Moto G54. The biggest gap was seen in PCMark Work which tests how the phone would perform when handling typical home user workloads. The POCO X6 Neo only got a score of 10726 here.

In GPU benchmarks, the POCO X6 Neo is pretty much neck and neck with the Lava Storm 5G in 3D Mark Wild Life. However, most of its GFXBench scores are considerably lower. Fortunately,

with Android 14. MIUI also has quite a bit of bloatware. Everything from Opera to Netflix to PhonePe is preinstalled. In fact, there are about 8 games preinstalled as well, which can be quite frustrating to clear during setup.

CAMERA

The POCO X6 Neo houses a dual camera array with a 108 MP Samsung ISOCELL HM6 primary sensor headlining the setup. The phone also comes with a nominal 2 MP depth camera. On the front, you've got a 16 MP selfie shooter. The phone is capable of shooting 1080p video at 30 fps from the rear and front cameras.



the raw performance you get won't get throttled much even through intensive use. The CPU Throttling Test showed no throttling even after running for 15 minutes, which is impressive.

Look, for a ₹16,000 smartphone, the POCO X6 Neo is incredibly smooth in the real world. I felt no lag or stutter during my usage and could game at Medium graphics without a hitch in BGMI or Call of Duty: Mobile. Does it have mind-blowing performance? No. Is it enough for the price? I think, yes. It doesn't get outclassed by any of its similarly-priced competitors that we've tested.

As for the UI, the phone ships with MIUI 14, which sits on top of Android 13. I really think POCO should have provided Android 14 out of the box since most of the latest phones ship

To start, let's talk about the daylight camera performance. The phone clicks decent photos with good amounts of detail and vivid colours. The dynamic range is a bit of a hit-or-miss. Occasionally, the highlights are slightly overblown. Close-up photos are decent, but they can be a bit soft at times.

Portrait photos are mediocre – the edge detection is not the best and detail retention could be better. Additionally, in harsh light, the phone does tend to overexpose the entirety of the photo.

The 8 MP ultrawide shooter is nothing to write home about; photos appear detailed in the centre but the sides miss out on some detail and look noisy. Selfie pictures are good in daylight, but the quality quickly degrades in low-light conditions.

BATTERY LIFE

The POCO X6 Neo houses a 5,000 mAh battery and features 33 W fast charging. The phone can last a whole day if you're a light to medium user but if you play a lot of intensive games or use the camera for a long time, you may need to plug it in by evening. In contrast, the Motorola G54 lasts much longer with its massive 6,000 mAh cell.

The POCO X6 Neo lost about 8 per cent battery while running Google Maps for an hour, which is on the higher side. It also lost 7 per cent battery in just 15 minutes of playing COD: Mobile. The 33 W charger takes over an hour and a half to charge the phone from empty to full.

VERDICT

The POCO X6 Neo is one of the best phones for content consumption under ₹16,000. Its incredibly slim bezels coupled with a bright AMOLED display ensure that you are in for a visual treat – at home or on the go. The phone also boasts an amazingly slim and lightweight build, perfect for day-to-day usage. However, it does miss the beat in some areas. For example, the copious amounts of bloatware is quite annoying and the battery life isn't the best in the segment. Moreover, the phone's performance is nothing special compared to the competition. Is the phone worth its asking price? Yes. The value aspect only crumbles if you're a power user who prioritises speedy performance and excellent battery life the most.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Dimensity 6080 | GPU: Mali-G57 MC2 | RAM: 8/12 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 128/256 GB UFS 2.2 | Display: 6.67" AMOLED FHD+ | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz | Instant touch sampling rate: 2160 Hz | Display protection: Gorilla Glass 5 | Cameras (rear): 108 MP ISOCELL HM6 + 2 MP Depth | Selfie camera: 16 MP | Video: 1080p at 30 fps | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 33 W | IP rating: IP54 | OS: MIUI 14, Android 13 | Colours: Astral Black, Horizon Blue, Martian Orange

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